

For two hundred years, work was the answer to *who are you*. The machine is quietly taking that answer back — and I think that can be the best thing that ever happened to us.

Somewhere after the factory whistle we made a strange trade. We let a job most of us never really chose stand in for a life. The thing that was imposed on us — the desk, the shift, the title on the badge — became the thing that defined us. We called it being a grown-up. We forgot it was a deal we never signed.

Now automation is undoing that deal, and faster than anyone guessed. The spreadsheet, the script, the form, the report — the machine is coming for the work no one ever loved. That frightens people, and I understand it. If the job that named you disappears, what is left of you?

EducatedTraveler exists because I believe the optimistic answer is the true one. What disappears is the *laboured work you didn't choose*. What remains — and grows rarer, and grows precious by the year — is the craft you would do for nothing: the thing made by hand, learned from a person who cared, in a real place.

This isn't wishful thinking; it's where the serious thinking keeps landing. Nearly a century ago Keynes imagined his grandchildren freed by machines to finally live well, and quarrelled only with what we'd do with the freedom. The people who study what artificial intelligence cannot touch keep returning to the same short list — the dexterity of the hand, the judgement of the senses, the patience of real mastery, the warmth between two people teaching and learning face to face. None of it substitutable. All of it earned, slowly, at the source.

Let the machine take the work no one chose. Keep — for yourself — the craft you'd have chosen anyway.

So the vision is a stubbornly hopeful one. A world where what defines you is your passion, not a role handed to you by someone else. Where the question stops being *what do you do for money* and becomes *what are you good at, what fills you, who taught you*. Where more people get to thrive inside a craft that gives them purpose and a bit of joy — and where the proof of a life is something you can do with your hands, not something a machine could have done instead.

That's the world EducatedTraveler is built to point you toward, and toward the people already living in it. Here is how I came to believe in it.

I left school at eighteen and went out into the world instead of staying in a classroom. Almost everything I know, I learned from someone who was good at something real and happy to share it.

I started cooking young — and not where a Frenchman is supposed to. The first kitchens that took me on were on the other side of the world, in Australia. Then I went to sea and cooked on boats for years, until the kitchen and the water were the same life.

I learned to sail in the bay of Sydney and on the Siam sea off Thailand. I raced the Atlantic once, Barbados to Bermuda — days of nothing but open water. I freedived the cenotes in Mexico, windsurfed the Caribbean and the lagoons of Portugal. None of it off a screen. Every bit of it from someone who actually did it, in the place they did it.

It was only after all that I came back to France — a Michelin kitchen, then my WSET, the wine qualification, in Paris. So the serious training came last, not first. Then superyacht chef, which carried me everywhere: the Med, French Polynesia, the Marquesas, the Galápagos, the Falklands, Brazil, a lot of Southeast Asia. I trekked the Himalaya in Nepal, and the jungle in Thailand and the Amazon. India stayed with me more than anywhere.

And everywhere I landed I did the same thing on my own time. I took the cooking class. I got lost in the markets. I hunted down the tables that were the real thing, not the ones in the guidebooks. Every place had someone proud of their craft who would teach you — if you showed up and paid attention. I'd been doing this for years before it had a name.

These days I also write Littoralicious, my food-and-sea publication — recipes worth the work, the science beneath them, the craft of cooking well aboard. It runs on the same instinct that runs everything else I do: go to the source, and trust only the real thing.

A machine can do almost anything now, and that got me thinking about what actually meant something to me. It was the slow stuff, learned by hand, from people who cared, in a real place. Turns out I'd been doing it since I was eighteen. I wanted to help other people find it.

WHAT I BUILT

So I made EducatedTraveler. It's not a shop, it's more of a bridge. There's the Atlas, a map I'm checking by hand, line by line, of where a craft is actually alive, ranked by the people around it and not by who pays me. And the Circle, which introduces you to the teachers, the schools, and the people already there. It connects you. The map and the Circle are free; the one paid thing is a Lab Week, and no money ever moves a line on the record.

The things worth having, you earn by doing them next to someone, and that's getting rarer the more the world automates.

THE INVITATION

Have a look at the Atlas, join the Circle, or just tell me what pulls you. That's enough to start.

A place, a person, your people. Earned, not bought.